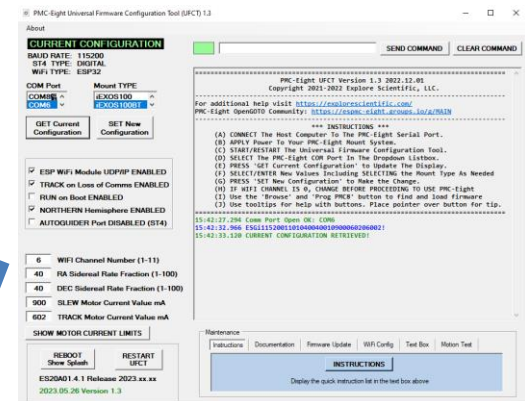


Setting up your new PMC8 Mount

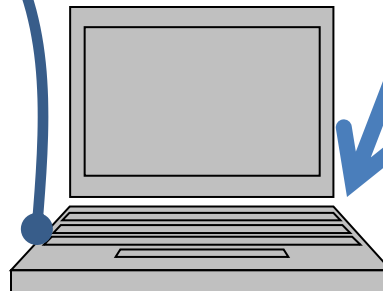
This sequence shows you how to connect the Universal Firmware Configuration Tool.
The UFCT is used to confirm that your new mount's firmware is current and correctly configured.

1. Power on your new PMC8 mount (All models)
2. Attach the USB cable.
(See notes "A" and "B")



3. Start (or download and install) the UFCT.
(see note "C")
4. Read and follow the instructions and Tooltips shown on the UFCT.
5. *There is more than one model of PMC8 mount.*

Pay particular attention to the mount type parameter shown, and ensure that it is set correctly for your specific mount.



Note “A” - The Cable:

If you have an EXOS2 or G11 PMC8, then you need a USB-to-serial cable with an embedded FTDI chip.

Examples: Explore Scientific USB-RS232-FTDI , Sabrent USB 2.0 to DB9 with FTDI chipset, DTECH USB 2.0 to DB9 with FTDI chipset., etc.

If you have an iExos-100, an FTDI chip is not required in the cable. This functionality is already built into its circuit board, and a basic USB A to USB Mini B cable rated for data will work.

Note “B” – The USB – to – Serial Driver:

Your Windows computer needs to convert your USB physical cable connection, into a high-speed serial connection to your PMC8 mount. It does this through the magic of driver software.

If you are on Windows 10 or 11 and you followed the documented sequence of starting up the UFCT *after* PMC8 power-up and USB connection, your Windows computer MAY have reached out to the internet, found the necessary driver and installed it for you. In this case, you should see “Virtual COM Port” values like “COM3” and “COM4” showing up in the “COM Port” field in the UFCT. Click on one and you should be able to start communicating with your mount.

If you are on an older version of Windows, or you do not see the COM port choices, you can get the necessary driver from here: <https://ftdichip.com/drivers/vcp-drivers/>
Install it with the FTDI installer. After it is installed, restart the UFCT and try again..

Note “C” – The UFCT Software.

This software tool is used to both to update PMC8 mount firmware, and to configure the stored parameters that determine the behavior of your mount hardware.

Download link: <https://explorescientific.ca/pages/software-and-downloads-for-pmc-eight-system/>

Factory-new mounts, or resale mounts, may require this step.

If you are a new owner of either, you should run the UFCT and confirm that your mount is running current firmware, and that it is configured correctly.

When you download and install the UFCT, it will start right up. If you are not ready to configure your PMC8 mount at that time, just shut it down until you are ready to proceed.